



The change from a child to an adult, called **adolescence**, happens during our teenage years.

In addition to the physical changes of puberty, this phase includes changes in behavior, emotions, and attitudes. These are triggered by changes in the hormones and in the brain.

PUBERTY

The first part of adolescence is puberty. The body grows rapidly and changes shape, and the reproductive system becomes active. Because puberty starts earlier in girls (age 10 to 12) than boys (age 12 to 14), girls initially grow faster than boys.

